

The Court previously noted that the minors' great aunt, Jenny Adkins, also filed a Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Persons. A Notice of Hearing has still not been filed and served to bring the matter properly before the Court. Letters of Temporary Guardianship were requested but denied following a hearing where the Court heard from the Tribe, the Temporary Guardians, Ms. Adkins and both parents. The Court found good cause to keep the temporary orders in place despite ICWA preference based upon a totality of the circumstances. The parents, including father who is a tribal member, both nominate Aaron and Jessica Souza who have helped raise both minors since birth. The Souzas have been the primary caregivers of the minors for seven months and due to the minors young age the Court found it would be detrimental to the minors to once again remove them from their home and known caregivers pending the hearing on the Petitions for Guardianship. Both Children's Services and the Tribe worked together and initially agreed that placement with the Souzas was in the minors best interest. All parties agreed at the time of hearing that the minors do not have any pre-existing relationship with Ms. Adkins. The Court concluded it continues to be in the best interest of the minors to keep the temporary orders in place pending the hearing on the Petitions and presentation of testimony from an Indian expert. However, that hearing cannot occur until the Petitions have been fully noticed and served.

This matter is also on calendar for confirmation of counsel. Jennifer Tescher has been appointed as counsel for the mother. Melissa Fanoe has been appointed as counsel for the father. Both Attorneys Tescher and Fanoe have confirmed their appointment. At the last hearing, Attorney Kristin Anderson was appointed as counsel for the minors. The Court previously made a referral to Children's Services. A report from Children's Services has not been received. The Tribe previously filed applications to commence juvenile court proceedings on June 23, 2026. Children's Services has three weeks from the date of the referral to commence juvenile dependency proceedings. Prob. Code § 1513. The matter is continued to **Monday, July 20, 2026, at 8:30 a.m. in Department 42** for further proceedings on the Petition for Appointment of Guardian of the Persons and confirmation of counsel. **No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF STRENGTH DELEON

CASE NUMBER: 25PG-0033144

This matter is on calendar pursuant to a Notice of Hearing filed by the Guardian, Jennifer Pierson, regarding a Petition for Termination of Guardianship. The Petition for Termination of Guardianship was dismissed by request of the Guardian at the hearing on May 4, 2026. If the Guardian wishes to pursue termination of the guardianship, a new petition is required to be filed.

This matter is also on calendar for status of filing a successor petition for guardianship. A successor petition has been filed by Freedom Fernald and is currently set for hearing on July 27, 2026. **No appearance is necessary on today's calendar.**

GUARDIANSHIP OF BRIAN EVANS IV

CASE NUMBER: 26PG-0033261

This matter is on calendar for confirmation of counsel and setting of a contested hearing regarding the competing petitions for guardianship filed by Kelli Combs and Charlene Harrell. Attorney Jennifer Tescher was previously appointed as counsel for the minor. **An appearance is**